

ELYSE & KERRY JEWEL
Conceptualists & Creative Producers
A lifetime of creating entertainment

Both Elyse and Kerry were born into the entertainment industry. Kerry's father was Jimmy Jewel, one half of legendary double act Jewel & Warris, when Kerry was christened at the London Palladium it was appropriate that the other great double act of the era, Laurel & Hardy, were present to wet his head.

They worked for two decades as successful writers and performers in both the UK and Australia. In 1985 they commenced their production careers when they developed Australia's first dinner theatres with the Hyatt Hotels in Australia and New Zealand and created a touring circuit that encompassed over 50 towns and cities.

They believe that the audience should be treated to the complete night out. The performance must not just be memorable, but the seats should be comfortable, access to the venue easy, tickets, programs and drinks obtained without lengthy queues. Too many people have been put off attending performances; not because the performance was not enjoyable, but the theatre seats had no leg room or tickets difficult to obtain or the theatre's location meant it was just too hard to get to.

Mindful of these needs, they endeavoured to always have an influence or control over both the venue in which their production was performing and the box office. The first point of contact for a potential customer is when they acquire the ticket from the box office; so, it must be a welcoming and not an off-putting experience. Otherwise, the customer is lost before he becomes a customer!

With all these factors in mind, it was in 1985 when they created the "Comedian's Co-Op" which started as a two months 'fill' at Sydney's Golden Garter, but in fact ran for eleven months and toured for two years.

At the Glenn Street Theatre, they produced 4 shows a year till 1995 making them one of the largest employers of actors and technicians in live commercial theatre.

They presented concerts all over Australia with piano virtuoso Roger Woodward; singing legend Cleo Laine flew to Australia to exclusively appear for the Jewels.

Their adaptation of "*Peter Pan*" was a massive commercial production that achieved sell out business. At a cost of \$12 million it was one of the largest and most lavish productions ever staged in Australia.

They were responsible for "*Saturday Night Fever*", "*The Soweto Gospel Choir*", the children's favourite "*High 5*", "*Sleeping Beauty on Ice*" and many more.

Their Sydney season of "*Fiddler on the Roof*" with the legendary Topol grossed \$5.4 million in its 8-week season.

"*The Anzac Tattoo*" and "*The Tattoo Spectacular*" was their creation and the next step on their creative journey.

Their eldest son, Dean, is a very successful producer in his own right and will be joining Mum and Dad for Monkey King.

Elyse and Kerry had some very dark days when their 23-year-old son died from injuries he sustained in a backstage accident. This saw the Jewels take many years away from work. They are now retuning with ***Monkey King Journey to the West***

Elyse and Kerry have undertaken a great deal of work for charity. The International Variety Club of Australia, the greatest children's charity in the world, recognised them with their coveted award for Contribution to Children.

A small selection of over 30 productions by Elyse & Kerry Jewel..

